## CLAIMS

What is claimed is:

1. A system for covert communication, comprising:

    - a plurality of movable, physical ground objects, wherein each object is colored with a specific, statistically rare color;
    - an imaging satellite configured to periodically capture images of a designated geographical area containing said ground objects; and
    - a remote data processing system configured to:
        - receive said images from the satellite;
        - execute a computer vision algorithm to identify the ground objects within the images based on their statistically rare color; and
        - decode a message based on a pre-defined meaning associated with the spatial arrangement of the identified ground objects.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the statistically rare color is a trademark-protected color.

3. The system of claim 1, wherein the ground objects are construction vehicles or shipping containers.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein at least one of the ground objects has an asymmetrical shape, and wherein the message is further decoded based on the rotational orientation of said asymmetrical object.

5. A method for covert, non-RF communication, comprising the steps of:

    - Physically arranging one or more movable ground objects of a distinctive color into a specific spatial configuration within a designated area;

- Capturing, via an orbiting satellite, a digital image of said designated area;
- Transmitting the image to a remote processing center; and
- At the processing center, automatically analyzing the image to identify said objects and decode a message based on their spatial configuration.

6. The method of claim 5, wherein the distinctive color is a trademark-protected color, and wherein the step of analyzing the image uses said color to distinguish the objects from environmental clutter.

7. The method of claim 5, wherein at least one of the objects is asymmetrical, and further comprising the step of encoding information in the rotational orientation of the asymmetrical object.

8. The method of claim 7, wherein the decoded message is a status update corresponding to one of a plurality of pre-defined states, each state being associated with a specific rotational orientation.